

Head Lice - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1398 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Qatar-localized UAT-only adult and pediatric pathway for suspected head lice, requiring confirmation, age/pregnancy review, safe product selection and safeguarding assessment.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [YES_NO] Have live lice actually been seen (not just nits/eggs)?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] Has any treatment already been tried?
3. [YES_NO] Are other close contacts also affected?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the exact age; is the patient pregnant/breastfeeding; and are there scalp infection, chemical exposure, failed treatments, immune suppression, neglect or safeguarding concerns?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Rash or Redness - Widespread

Have no live lice been found, and is a widespread rash or redness the main concern?

A widespread rash without confirmed live lice belongs in the Rash or Redness - Widespread pathway.

1. Disposition level 70

Have medicated treatments already been tried without success?

NHS.UK guidance recommends speaking to a pharmacist about alternative treatments if the first attempt hasn't worked.

1. Disposition level 50

Is this a new case of suspected or confirmed head lice with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance states head lice can be treated without primary-care review, using wet combing or pharmacy treatments.

Advice

Head lice treatment not working

- Ask a pharmacist about alternative treatment options.
- Call Back If: lice persist after a second treatment.

Confirmed head-lice management review

- Confirm live lice with appropriate combing and obtain pharmacist/clinician advice before selecting treatment for age, pregnancy, breastfeeding, allergies and prior exposure. Do not use pesticides, veterinary products, essential oils, heat or flammable remedies.
- Call Back If: scalp infection or chemical injury; lice persist despite correctly supervised treatment.

First aid

References

- NHS.UK, "Head lice", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/head-lice/> (page last reviewed 22 April 2024)

Provenance

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